

A SiS630 is a PCI-based display card, which lacks hardware support for OpenGL. The minimum requirements are an AGP card for the game to run in OpenGL. One of the cheapest solutions is the GeForce MX 440, which costs about Rs 1,700.

Q I am in the process of finalising the configuration of my new PC, and want to know whether 512 MB of RAM is sufficient to run Maya, or should I opt for 1 GB of RAM?

Kumaresh

A Minimum memory requirements depend on the applications you use. For office applications 256 MB is enough; for 2D image editing tools, 512 MB should be sufficient, while for AV and 3D, a minimum of 1 GB is necessary. Basically, as much RAM as you can afford and cram into your system is recommended. Maya will definitely run with 512 MB of RAM, but will be sluggish.

Q One of our clients wants to purchase an AMD Athlon 64-based system. He is a graphic designer, and uses Photoshop most often, working with files of sizes in excess of 500 MB. What system would be ideal here? I downloaded Microsoft XP, the 64-bit edition. Does it give good performance with the Athlon 64? Also, how should I configure the system for best performance?

Krishna Prasad

A You should opt for an Athlon 64. It gives better performance than the Intel Prescott. Also, in memory-intensive applications like Photoshop, an Athlon 64 will give much better performance, as the memory controller is within the CPU, as against the Prescott, where the memory controller resides on the Northbridge. The second factor is memory. The RAM needs to be high enough, say 768 (512 + 256) MB.

Q I have a five-PC network on a CAT 5 cable and a hub. What do I need to set up a fibre optic cable network? What's needed to set up a WiFi network? Also, please let me know the approximate costs involved?

Anil Gupta